Performance and Promotion Policy

Kestrel Data Labs Pvt. Ltd. (fictional company created for this project)

1. Review cycles

Performance is reviewed twice a year, in April and October. Each review includes a self-assessment, manager assessment and, for levels L4 and above, feedback from at least three peers.

2. Rating scale

Employees are rated on a 5-point scale: 1 Does not meet expectations, 2 Partially meets, 3 Meets, 4 Exceeds, 5 Outstanding. Ratings are calibrated across each department before they are shared.

3. Career levels

The career framework has levels L1 (entry) to L8 (principal / director). Each level has a published description of expected scope and impact.

4. Promotion eligibility

To be eligible for promotion, an employee must have spent at least 18 months in their current level and must have received a rating of 4 or higher in each of the last two review cycles. Promotions take effect from 1 May or 1 November, following the review cycle.

5. Performance improvement plan

An employee rated 1 in a cycle, or rated 2 in two consecutive cycles, is placed on a Performance Improvement Plan (PIP) of 60 days with clear, measurable goals and fortnightly check-ins.

6. Salary review

Annual salary revisions are effective from 1 April and are linked to the April review rating and market benchmarks.